

KICKSTART 2026

WISCONSIN'S ENTREPRENEUR CONFERENCE

SATURDAY
OCT 10

VENUE Sylvan Hill Park	CITY Wausau, WI	ATTENDANCE 150 target	RUN TIME 13 hours	TICKET \$399
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WHAT IT IS

A thirteen-hour working conference for the people who run Wisconsin's businesses — keynotes, hands-on workshops to choose from, panel discussions, all-day coffee, and an evening networking reception at Sylvan Hill Park at peak fall color. Every session ends with knowledge each attendee can implement into their business the same week.

WHY WE'RE BRINGING ON SPONSORS

- **To build it right the first time.** Ticket revenue funds a decent event; sponsorship funds one people come back to.
- **The sponsors belong in the room.** Banks, insurance, CPAs, law, real estate, IT, staffing — the firms that serve owners are who attendees need.
- **Every session is recorded** and released on a rolling schedule — so sponsor recognition keeps earning views long after October 10.

WHAT'S IN THIS DECK

2	KEYNOTES	The main-stage headliners and why they draw a room.
3	INSTRUCTORS	The workshop instructors, plus the live roster QR.
4	THE DAY	Full schedule, block by block — and what gets recorded.
5	THE AUDIENCE	Who attends, what they spend, where they come from.
6	MARKETING PLAN	Paid video across eleven Wisconsin markets, speaker content, podcast placements.
7	SPONSORSHIP TIERS	Four tiers with price, availability, and the ticket value included in each.
8	SPECIALTY	After Hours Power Hour, lanyards, coffee, and Wi-Fi.

TICKET PRICING

TICKET	PRICE
Early bird	\$149
General admission	\$399

Sponsor ticket allotments on page 7 are valued at the \$399 general admission rate.

Year one, stated plainly. This is the first KickStart, so there's no attendance history to show — but the venue is reserved, the program built, the speakers confirmed, and the campaign budgeted. Year-one sponsors get founding recognition and a verified post-event report: real numbers, not estimates.

THE KEYNOTES

MAIN-STAGE HEADLINERS

KEYNOTES

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No theory. Every headliner on this stage has built, scaled, or sold a real business — and each one is a reason someone drives across Wisconsin for a single Saturday. The full, continually updated roster lives at summit.kicklick.com.



HEADLINER · CONFIRMED

Antonio Centeno

YOUTUBER & ENTREPRENEUR

A Marine officer who turned a men's-style channel into a 4-million-subscriber brand — built from a Wisconsin town of 1,000 people. His keynote is a clinic on how attention compounds into a business that lasts.

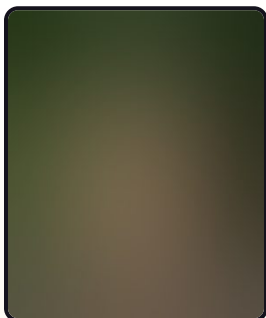


HOST · CONFIRMED

Tony Jordan Ruffi

FOUNDER, KICKCLICK · YOUR HOST

More than 100 businesses grown and four political races won. Founder of KickLick and host of the *Real Common Sense* podcast. He emcees the day and closes the main stage on turning a good year into a great one.



ANNOUNCING SOON

Special Headliner

ANNOUNCING SOON

Photos as published on summit.kicklick.com. The Special Headliner is under wraps — announcing soon.

WHAT THE HEADLINERS DO FOR A SPONSOR

- **They are the reason the room fills.** A 4-million-subscriber creator is why an owner gives up a Saturday and drives two hours to Wausau.
- **Every keynote is filmed** and released on a rolling schedule, so sponsor recognition rides on the sessions people came for — well into 2027.

THE INSTRUCTORS

WHO TEACHES THE WORKSHOP ROOMS

INSTRUCTORS

8

Keynote speakers light the fire; the instructors put tools in attendees' hands. These are the operators teaching the hands-on workshop rooms attendees choose between across the day.

	CONFIRMED Andrew Rohm Agency owner · Marketing Built the U.S.'s #1-ranked real-estate marketing agency by age 20.		CONFIRMED Brady Penfield Content creator · Marketing Creator and political player who knows how attention gets earned online.		PENDING Eric Thomas Serial entrepreneur · Grit A gym, a supplement line, a studio, a café — one relentless builder.
	CONFIRMED Mitch Bram Clothier · Sales Selling since grade school; youngest hire in Tom James history at 19.		CONFIRMED Roy Romano Restaurateur · Money 17 years pricing Wausau's most authentic Mexican restaurant.		CONFIRMED Yauo Yang Community leader · Operations Iraq War veteran, founder of The Joseph Project, elected leader.
	CONFIRMED Jacob VandenPlas Farmer & founder · Story Army vet, regenerative farmer, nonprofit founder — a masterclass in narrative.		CONFIRMED Derek Heikkinen HR consultant · Operations Wausau's HR pro on hiring, retention, and the hard conversations.	 FULL ROSTER summit.kicklick.com	

WHY THE LINEUP MATTERS TO A SPONSOR

- **These are draws, not filler** — a 4M-subscriber creator and a room of proven Wisconsin operators are why someone drives two hours to Wausau on a Saturday.
- **Every speaker and instructor is filmed**, and sponsors who commit early are named in every rolling speaker reveal — the most-shared content we produce between now and October.

THE DAY

FULL SCHEDULE — SATURDAY, OCTOBER 10

DOORS TO CLOSE

13 HRS

7:00 AM to 8:00 PM. Two keynote blocks, hands-on workshops to choose from, panel discussions, catered meals, all-day coffee, and an evening networking reception — thirteen sessions in all. Session speakers are announced on a rolling basis at summit.kicklick.com.

Keynote

Workshop

Panel

Break / Meal / Networking

MORNING

7:00	REGISTRATION & COFFEE
9:00	Morning Kick-Off
9:30	Opening Keynote KEYNOTE
10:00	Breakout Workshops CHOOSE 1 OF 3 ▶ AI for Business — The Basics ▶ Content Creation for Business ▶ How to Lead Effectively
10:45	BREAK
11:00	What’s Stopping You From Scaling? PANEL
11:30	Breakout Workshops CHOOSE 1 OF 2 ▶ Build Your First AI Employee ▶ The Closing Edge — Close More Deals
12:30	LUNCH

AFTERNOON & EVENING

1:45	Afternoon Kick-Off
2:00	Keynote KEYNOTE
2:30	Breakout Sessions CHOOSE 1 OF 3 ▶ Money Tips & Tricks for Businesses ▶ 10x Your Network ▶ Business Grit — Underdog Stories (Panel)
3:15	BREAK
3:30	Multimillion-Dollar CEO Panel PANEL
4:15	Keynote KEYNOTE
4:45	Growing a YouTube Channel to 4 Million Subscribers KEYNOTE
5:45	BREAK
6:00	Closing Keynote KEYNOTE
7:00	HOOR OF POWER — NETWORKING RECEPTION

EVERY SESSION IS RECORDED

- All keynotes, all workshops, and every panel discussion are professionally filmed and released on a rolling schedule after the event.
- Sponsor recognition attached to that footage keeps working into 2027 — and becomes the marketing engine for year two.
- Sponsorship maps directly onto this schedule: Platinum presents a **panel**, Gold presents a **workshop**, the After Hours Power Hour sponsor owns the **7:00 PM reception**.
- Each of those is a block people chose to attend — and each one is on camera.

THE AUDIENCE

WHO YOU'LL BE IN FRONT OF ALL DAY

TARGET
150

150
ATTENDEE TARGET

~68%
OWNERS & FOUNDERS

13 hrs
TIME ON SITE

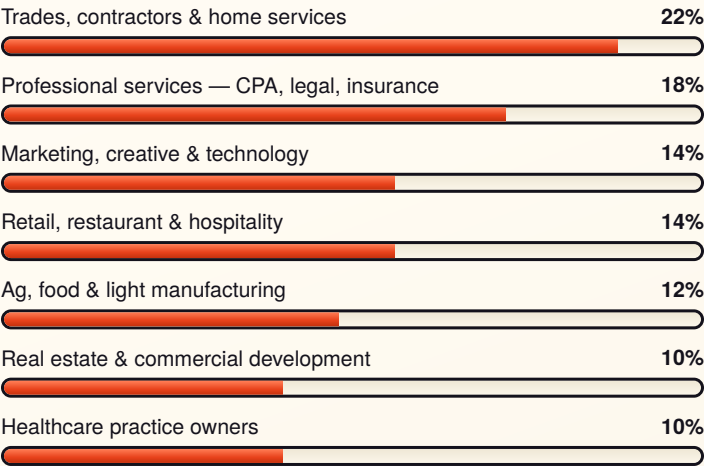
11
MARKETS DRAWN FROM

Who we're building this for: the owner-operator with two to fifty employees who is past survival and stuck on growth. People who sign the checks and can act on what they learn before the week is out.

FOR SPONSORS ONLY — NOT PUBLIC

The **150 target** above is the public number. Between us: if the first 150 sell out, we open a second release of **50 more, up to 200 total**. Size your footprint and ticket allotment for a room that could be a third larger.

INDUSTRY MIX — TARGET



ROLE IN THE BUSINESS

ROLE	TARGET
Owner, founder or partner	68%
Executive or manager with budget authority	27%
Early-stage and pre-launch founders	5%

Roughly 90% of the room can approve a purchase without asking anyone.

COMPANY SIZE

HEADCOUNT	TARGET
1–5 employees	40%
6–20 employees	35%
21–50 employees	18%
50+ employees	7%

ANNUAL REVENUE

BAND	TARGET
Under \$250K	26%
\$250K – \$1M	34%
\$1M – \$5M	28%
\$5M+	12%

WHERE THEY COME FROM

ORIGIN	TARGET
Wausau metro & Marathon County	20%
Outlying markets — Stevens Point, Appleton, Green Bay, Rhinelander, La Crosse, Minocqua, Fond du Lac, Madison, Eau Claire, Milwaukee	80%

Four-fifths travel in, which is what makes this a statewide audience rather than a local one.

HOW TO READ THESE NUMBERS

Every figure here is a **target for a first-year event**, not a historical result. **Every sponsor receives a post-event report with actual attendance, demographics, expo traffic, and campaign reach.** If we miss, you'll see by how much.

HOW WE FILL THE ROOM

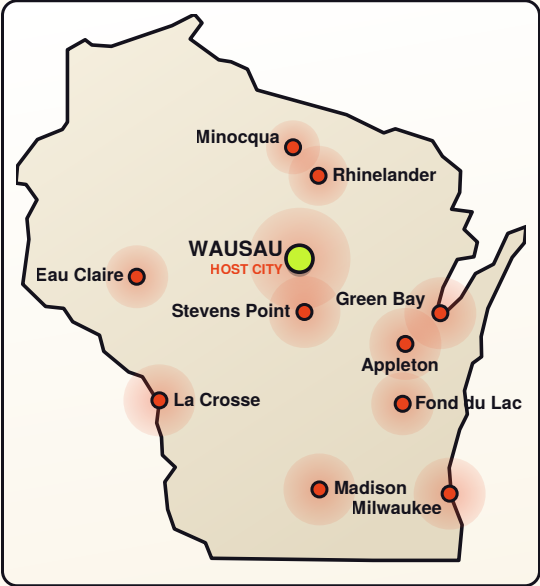
THE MARKETING PLAN

AD MARKETS

11

KickLick is a marketing agency — running the campaign is the part we already know how to do. Every tier is woven into it, so your visibility starts the day you commit.

PAID VIDEO — 11 MARKETS



MARKET	DRIVE
Wausau — host	—
Stevens Point	35 min
Rhinelander	1 hr 15
Minocqua	1 hr 25
Appleton	1 hr 30
Green Bay	1 hr 45
Fond du Lac	1 hr 45
Eau Claire	1 hr 45
La Crosse	2 hr 15
Madison	2 hr 30
Milwaukee	3 hr

CHANNEL PLAN

- 1. Paid video.** YouTube pre-roll and in-feed plus Facebook and Instagram video, geo-targeted across all eleven markets and narrowed to business owners and decision-makers — not broad geography.
- 2. Organic speaker content.** Short-form video filmed with speakers ahead of the event, built to be shared on its own merits. Rolling announcements give the campaign a reason to post every week until October.
- 3. Podcast advertising.** Video and audio placements inside entrepreneurship podcasts, including *Real Common Sense with Tony Jordan Ruffi* — the highest-intent inventory available to us.

WHERE SPONSORS APPEAR

- Event website with logo and link, from day one of commitment
- Rolling speaker announcements across all channels
- Video creative and end cards — Presenting and Platinum
- Email sequence to KickLick’s regional list and all registrants
- On-site: stage backdrop, program, signage, expo, stage mentions
- Recorded session releases** that keep running well past October 10

THE LONG TAIL

Every keynote, workshop and panel is filmed. Sessions release on a rolling schedule after the event, so recognition attached to that footage earns views into 2027 — and becomes the engine for year two.

CAMPAIGN TIMELINE

PHASE 1 · NOW – AUG

Launch & Reveal

Site live, registration open, weekly speaker reveals.

PHASE 2 · AUG – SEPT

Campaign Ramp

Paid video live in all eleven markets. Podcast placements begin.

PHASE 3 · SEPT – OCT 9

Final Push

Retargeting, seat-scarcity messaging, regional email.

PHASE 4 · OCT 10 & AFTER

Event & Long Tail

Live day-of coverage, then rolling releases into 2027.

SPONSORSHIP TIERS

PRICE, AVAILABILITY & TICKET VALUE

TOTAL SLOTS

31

Four tiers, priced by how deeply you're built into the day. Every package includes general admission tickets — valued below at the **\$399** rate — so your team is in the room, not just on the signage. First-come; when a tier fills, it closes.

PRESENTING SPONSOR

1 AVAILABLE · EXCLUSIVE

\$20,000

15 TICKETS · \$5,985 VALUE

- Event carries your name — **“presented by”**
- Opening remarks from the main stage
- Largest logo placement of any sponsor
- 15 general admission tickets
- Recognition throughout the event
- Featured in all marketing materials
- Social media recognition, full campaign
- Named in recorded session releases

PLATINUM SPONSOR

3 AVAILABLE

\$10,000

10 TICKETS · \$3,990 VALUE

- Expo booth
- A panel “brought to you by” you — on camera
- 10 general admission tickets
- Website recognition
- Stage backdrop recognition
- Social media promotion

GOLD SPONSOR

7 AVAILABLE

\$5,000

6 TICKETS · \$2,394 VALUE

- Expo booth
- A workshop “brought to you by” you — on camera
- 6 general admission tickets
- Program ad
- Website logo

BRAND PARTNER

20 AVAILABLE

\$1,000

2 TICKETS · \$798 VALUE

- Tabletop display booth
- Website listing
- 2 general admission tickets

On the “brought to you by” sessions: nothing at KickStart is exclusive or gated — every panel and workshop is open to anyone with a ticket. A sponsored session simply carries your name and branding; it's real program content, not a sales pitch, and it's filmed. You get the introduction, the branding, and the association with a session people chose to attend.

SPECIALTY SPONSORSHIPS

OWN ONE PART OF THE DAY OUTRIGHT

NAMED
4

These sit alongside the tiers on the previous page. Each attaches your name to one specific, unmissable part of the day — on its own or added to any tier.

AFTER HOURS POWER HOUR

1 AVAILABLE · EXCLUSIVE

\$10,000

NETWORKING RECEPTION

- Full sponsorship of the evening reception
- Opening remarks to the reception
- Your name on it in all programming
- Recognition throughout the space

Why this one goes first: the reception is the part people stay for — no sessions competing for attention. Your remarks land on a relaxed room already talking to each other.

LANYARD SPONSOR

1 AVAILABLE · EXCLUSIVE

\$5,000

EVERY ATTENDEE, ALL DAY

- Your logo on every attendee lanyard
- Recognition on the event website

Every person in the park wears your brand for **thirteen hours**, and it appears in every photo and every frame of recorded footage shot on the floor.

IN-KIND SPONSORSHIPS

For companies that would rather provide something than write a check. Both carry full sponsor recognition on the website, in the program, and on-site.

IN-KIND · 1 AVAILABLE

COFFEE SPONSOR

Provide coffee service for the full thirteen hours. Your brand sits at the highest-traffic point in the venue — everyone comes back to the coffee more than once.

IN-KIND · 1 AVAILABLE

WI-FI SPONSOR

Provide connectivity for the entire event. Naming rights on the network and splash page — every attendee sees your name in their first five minutes.

WHAT EVERY SPONSOR GETS, REGARDLESS OF TIER

- A **verified post-event report** — real attendance, demographics, session and expo traffic, campaign reach.
- Inclusion in the recorded session library** — recognition that keeps earning views well past the event.
- Category consideration** — tell us who you'd rather not share a tier with.

RESERVING A PACKAGE

Packages are held first-come and confirmed with a signed agreement. To claim one or build a custom fit, contact **Tony Jordan Ruffi at KickLick** — (715) 314-3216 or info@kicklick.com. Full details and the current roster: summit.kicklick.com.